



If you get sick in Japan

Written by a nurse working in Japanese healthcare, for visitors. Keep this with your passport. Most of what people get wrong here costs them money, time, or both.

An ambulance is free.

In Japan, calling an ambulance and being transported costs nothing — including for foreign visitors. If a life is at risk, call 119 and do not hesitate. You will never be billed for the ride.

The two numbers

119

Fire and ambulance. 24 hours, free. Say **kyu-kyu desu** — "it's an emergency". Then say your address slowly, or hand the phone to someone nearby.

#7119

Medical advice line. Use it when you don't know whether this is serious. Available in Tokyo and many other areas; some regions use a different number.

What to do, in order

1 Is it life-threatening?

Chest pain, trouble breathing, heavy bleeding, loss of consciousness, a bad fall. Call 119 now. Skip the rest of this page.

2 Not sure?

Call #7119, or message your nurse contact during the day. Describe your symptoms and let someone else judge.

3 It can wait a few hours?

Go to a clinic rather than a hospital. Clinics are faster and cheaper. Most close by 18:00 and all day Sunday.

4 Before you are examined, call your travel insurer.

If you don't, you will pay the whole bill yourself and claim it back later — if they accept it.

This guide is information, not medical advice. We do not diagnose or treat. In an emergency, call 119.



A nurse you can message

Scan for the full service page in English, Japanese and Chinese — symptom phrases, hospital accompaniment and medical interpreting in Tokyo.



Point at these

Japanese staff will understand these instantly. Point at the line that fits, or show the whole page.

日本語が話せません。助けていただけますか。

I don't speak Japanese. Could you help me?

熱があります

I have a fever

吐き気がします

I feel nauseous

お腹が痛いです

My stomach hurts

頭が痛いです

I have a headache

息が苦しいです

I can't breathe well

薬のアレルギーがあります

I'm allergic to some medicines

海外旅行保険に入っています。キャッシュレス対応はできますか。

I have travel insurance. Can you bill them directly?

Money, and how not to lose it

1 The ride is free. The treatment is not.

Without Japanese public insurance you are billed as a private patient, which can cost more than it would for a resident. A clinic visit is often ¥5,000–20,000; a hospital far more.

2 Bring cash.

Around ¥20,000. Many clinics still do not take cards.

3 Ask for these three papers before you leave.

A medical certificate (診断書), an itemised receipt (明細つき領収書), and the medication information sheet. Without them your insurer can refuse the claim.